

PLSC 197 / SODA 110N: Social Data, Technology, and Artificial Intelligence

Applied Lab One: Data Visualization

Part I: No-Code Tools

Lab

The goal for this week-long-lab is to familiarize you with some of the no-code tools available for visualizing data. This lab will be assigned in three parts: A Monday-to-Wednesday assignment (*Part I*), a Wednesday-to-Friday assignment (*Part II*), and a third part due next week (*Part III*). This is *Part I*.

The entire lab will rely on the 2019 subset of the [World Development Indicators](#) (WDI) data that we used as our example data in class. Those data have ≈ 40 variables on roughly 215 countries in the world, with values measured in 2019. The description of those data is [here](#), and the data itself is [here](#), in `.csv` format.

Part I of the lab assignment is really simple:

1. Upload the data into one of the (non-AI) no-code visualization sites/apps mentioned in class (they are listed, with links, in Monday's slides).
2. Choose *one* continuous variable, and *one* discrete variable. Pick ones that are of interest to you; be sure not to choose the same variable for both.
3. Use the app to create visual summaries / plots of:
 - (a) The continuous variable,
 - (b) The discrete variable,
 - (c) The two variables together.¹

Details

You should complete (or, at least, make progress toward completing) this part of the lab before Wednesday's class (September 16, 2026), and come to class on that day prepared to discuss your preliminary work and ask questions. The entire lab exercise is mandatory, and is worth a possible 150 points. **Points will be assessed upon completion of all three parts, the last of which will be due on Friday, September 25, 2026.**

¹There are a few ways to do this, all of which depend on the choice of app. If you struggle here, don't worry; we'll cover this in class.